

Match the Question to the Approach

CFAN 3091V | Week 5 Monday Workshop

Names: _____ Date: _____

Due: At the end of class.

Complete Sections 1-4 in class. Section 5 is a reminder for work outside class.

These practice questions were written for this exercise, not taken from a student's thesis. Begin on your own for two minutes, then compare with a partner.

1. What Would Count as an Answer?

For each question, jot the answer's form and evidence you would collect (e.g., a frequency from records, or an account of a decision from interviews). Then mark **QN** = **quantitative**, **QL** = **qualitative**, or **?** = **needs clarification**. For a question marked **?**, name the word or detail you need clarified.

1. How much nitrate-nitrogen leaves tile-drained corn fields in southern Minnesota during a single drainage season?

Answer/evidence: _____ Approach: _____

2. How do first-generation students in this college decide whether to pursue an honors thesis?

Answer/evidence: _____ Approach: _____

3. Does a cereal rye cover crop reduce spring weed density compared with no cover crop?

Answer/evidence: _____ Approach: _____

4. What does "sustainability" mean to the managers of mid-size dairy operations who use the word in their marketing?

Answer/evidence: _____ Approach: _____

5. How often do food-shelf clients in the metro area report running out of food before the end of the month?

Answer/evidence: _____ Approach: _____

6. Why do some producers abandon a conservation practice after adopting it?

Answer/evidence: _____ Approach: _____

7. Is a plant-based protein isolate as acceptable to consumers as a dairy protein isolate in a frozen dessert?

Answer/evidence: _____ Approach: _____

8. What is the process by which a county water-planning group reaches a decision about a contested drainage project?

Answer/evidence: _____ Approach: _____

9. Does forest thinning change the density of a bird species over five years?

Answer/evidence: _____ Approach: _____

10. What is it like to manage a family farm through a transition to organic certification?

Answer/evidence: _____ Approach: _____

11. How many hours per week do students in this college spend in paid employment during the semester?

Answer/evidence: _____ Approach: _____

12. How do wildlife technicians describe the judgment calls they make when field protocols do not fit the conditions in front of them?

Answer/evidence: _____ Approach: _____

2. Defend Two Difficult Choices

Choose the two questions you disagreed about most. If you agreed on all 12, choose the two where another interpretation seems most plausible. Explain two ways to interpret each question and what evidence you would collect to answer it each way.

First choice

Question number: _____

One way to interpret this question, and the evidence needed to answer it:

Another way to interpret this question, and the evidence needed to answer it:

The interpretation we chose, or what we still need clarified:

Second choice

Question number: _____

One way to interpret this question, and the evidence needed to answer it:

Another way to interpret this question, and the evidence needed to answer it:

The interpretation we chose, or what we still need clarified:

3. Change What Would Count as an Answer

Choose one question. Keep its topic, but rewrite it to call for the other approach. If your question could mean more than one thing, first state how you are interpreting it.

Original question number: _____

Original approach and interpretation: _____

Rewritten:

Underline the words you changed. What evidence would you now need?

4. Compare the Conclusions

Use your original and rewritten questions from Section 3. Imagine evidence has been collected using a suitable design. Write **hypothetical** conclusions, not reported findings. Do not invent numerical results.

Original question

A conclusion this study could support:

A claim this evidence would not justify, and why:

Rewritten question

A conclusion this study could support:

A claim this evidence would not justify, and why:

What could you learn from the rewritten study that the original study would leave unanswered?

5. To Do Outside of Class

Before you leave, make a note in your planner or notebook: Work on my own research question(s) before Wednesday's class.

When you return to your questions, consider:

- What would an answer look like, and what evidence would I need?
- Which approach fits, and why?
- What do I still need to ask my advisor about the approach?

Bring your question(s), notes, and Week 4 search work to Wednesday's **Rebuild Your Question** workshop. These reflections are preparation for Wednesday; they are not part of the worksheet due today.